



Toyota's Wooden Concept Car

Toyota's Setsuna is the concept car to debut from a major automaker this year, this concept roadster is made entirely of wood. <http://dgit.in/Tsetsuna>



Cheap BB Android smartphone?

BlackBerry is planning two mid-range smartphones for the year 2016. One with a physical keyboard, and another with a full touchscreen. <http://dgit.in/CheapBB>

Origins

A widely accepted rodent

The technical innovation behind a computer mouse was already in place even 50 years ago. Douglas Engelbart and his lead engineer Bill English made their first working mouse prototype in the 1960s in



The Engelbart mouse

their lab at the Stanford Research Institute (SRI). They actually named it the mouse due to the cord extending out of the back portion of the device, which looked similar to a tail. This entire idea had evolved from earlier developments of a trackball, which

involved multiple rolling discs with a rolling ball. Whenever the ball was rolled, the movement of the connected discs created signals at contacts with wires in the device. Each contact conveyed a certain movement to the digital computer which used that to plot the position of the pointer on the display.

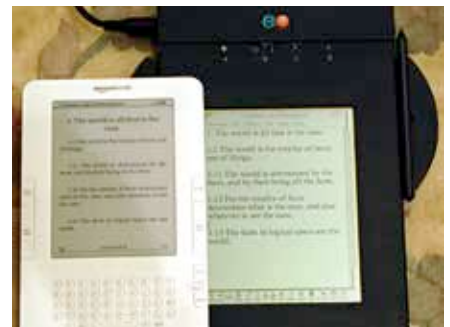
It was many years later that the mouse was used famously with the Xerox Alto at the Xerox Palo Alto Research Centre. In 1979, it was this very same PARC lab that was (now famously) toured by Steve Jobs, and is said to have been the source of inspiration for the mouse-driven interface that Apple eventually developed for the highly successful Macintosh computers released in the 1970s. (and as some would say, the Microsoft Windows interface as well)

Optical mice were made affordable by using a rubber tracking ball that worked in a way similar to the original trackball technology. Also, most mouse model designs have used either a two button or a three button interface, with the

exception of Apple that had stayed with a simplified one button interface through and through. Further developments saw the inclusion of a scroll dial, extra buttons and even gyroscopic capabilities in some models that detected hand waves.

A touching moment

Many of us would be surprised to know that the touch and tablet based interface was actually invented before the modern day mouse. In the 1950s and 60s, such



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